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Science funding plan would give AI a boost

Current research model could be at risk

By Allyson Chiu and Michaela Towfighi
GLOBE STAFF

A new White House blueprint for scientific research is drawing mixed reactions from Massachusetts scientists, with some praising its focus on innovation and others fearful it presages a shift away from the longstanding research partnership between the federal government and universities.

The 120-plus-page report, “Science: A New Golden Age,” released Tuesday, would drastically reshape the country’s ap-

proach to science funding by making large investments in artificial intelligence, robotics, and private-public partnerships. It also proposes additional spending in science and technology education, programs for early-career scientists, and backing unconventional ideas through a “golden ticket” program that rewards higher-risk research.

Those involved in industry partnerships on AI say the recommendations validate their work. Other scientists, howev-

SCIENCE, Page A6

‘I feel even more renewed urgency now with the incredibly painful reminder that every street matters in Boston.’

MAYOR MICHELLE WU

After crash, Wu outlines steps to better protect bike lanes

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

Days after emotionally pledging to take steps to make the city’s streets safer, Boston Mayor Michelle Wu said Friday that the city will install more concrete barriers on bike lanes and fix sidewalks and curb ramps among other changes in the wake of a crash earlier this

month that killed city planner Louisa Gag.

Wu laid out the plans in an open letter to city residents that her office released Friday, following renewed pressure from bike and transit advocates after Gag was hit and killed while cycling on Tremont Street two weeks ago.

An 18-wheel recycling truck

struck Gag on July 9 when it maneuvered around a turning vehicle, the Globe has reported. No one has been charged in the crash.

In an interview, Wu said her administration will prioritize the most dangerous gaps in the existing network of bike lanes with either temporary or permanent protections, starting

with the streets around Boston Common and the Public Garden.

“I feel even more renewed urgency now with the incredibly painful reminder that every street matters in Boston,” Wu said, emphasizing the effort will take time and resources.

“It is a million details about
STREETS, Page A7



CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF

A WAVE OF EMOTION

Judy Lake, 73, of Hull, returned to shore after spending time in the water at Nantasket Beach on Friday. Although she has arthritis and uses a cane, the ocean is “my passion,” she said. Lake lost her partner of 28 years, Jimmy Loring, two years ago. “It was a blow,” she said. “I’m still trying to figure out where I am. It’s not a happy place to be . . . unless I’m here.”

Flowers have BSO brass seeing red at Tanglewood

Protest for Nelsons brings a tightening of audience rules

By A.Z. Madonna
GLOBE STAFF

LENOX — When is a rose not just a rose? When the Boston Symphony Orchestra is involved.

Whether worn by orchestra members or listeners in the audience, red flowers are being used to express support for departing music director Andris Nelsons and the musicians who love him, a silent but unmissable symbol of the ongoing crisis at the BSO.

The public display seems to have perturbed orchestra officials enough that they are now directing ushers and other staff at Tanglewood, the BSO’s summer home, to caution anyone in the audience seen with a bag of flowers.

According to a BSO document obtained by the Globe, the staffers have been instructed to preemptively tell those people that distributing materials isn’t allowed, advise them to stash the flowers out of sight, and then also alert public safety staff. If the person is subsequently caught handing out a flower, they are to be issued a formal warning and asked to leave if deemed necessary.

A BSO spokesperson verified those instructions, and later clarified it was standard practice for staffers to inform public safety if someone is observed breaching any Tanglewood poli-



BSO, Page A10

As deadline nears, Somerville still hesitant on body cams

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — For many years, it seemed all but certain that police officers patrolling the streets here would soon have body cameras strapped to their chests like they do in Boston, Cambridge, and Medford. Somerville city officials had backed the technology, and key funding was in place.

But the cameras have never been deployed.

Facing a tight budget year and fissures over how body camera footage should be collected and viewed, officials aren’t so sure they should follow the lead of their neighbors even though they have a body-worn camera plan negotiated and ready to go.

With a deadline fast approaching for a use-it-or-lose it state grant of

about \$232,000, some elected leaders are revisiting a question about body cameras many thought was settled long ago: Is Somerville better off without them?

“It’s a weird position to be in,” said City Councilor Jon Link. “If you’d told me a couple years ago that I’d be voting to reject something that would bring body-worn cameras to the police, I would have laughed at

you.”

Body cameras have long had the support of police reform groups, who say they help get justice when officers misbehave and lend clarity to high-profile cases when someone is hurt or killed by law enforcement.

But support in some circles has begun to dim amid new skepticism about surveillance technology tools.

BODY CAMS, Page A7

Spotlight’s no longer on Swift’s R.I. home

Years ago, she was everywhere in the village. Not anymore.

By Christopher Gavin
GLOBE STAFF

WESTERLY, R.I. — Even when she’s not around, she’s the loudest woman this town has ever seen.

Taylor Swift’s purchase in 2013 of a 12,657-square-foot mansion on Bluff Avenue in Westerly’s Watch Hill has left an indelible mark on this tiny seaside village. Her annual celebrity-studded Fourth of July party is the stuff of tabloid legend. Enshrining the historic 1903 home in song on her “Folklore” album further fueled the landmark status of Swift’s vacation spot. Fans consider taking a peek at the property as part of their itinerary. Mere rumors the superstar might have held her nuptials in Watch Hill drew throngs of fans to the town. Of course they end-

ed up disappointed when the pop icon decided to wed at Madison Square Garden instead.

By 2017, an editorial in The Westerly Sun declared Swift “one of us,” writing she had taken to the beach town like a local. She had been seen shopping at McQuade’s Marketplace and Miceli’s Furniture, and grabbing ice cream with fellow musician Ed Sheeran at Mel’s Downtown Creamery in nearby Pawcatuck, Conn.

Yet as Swift’s celebrity crossed into the stratosphere, locals say her visibility around Watch Hill has faded. It’s been years since Swift has been seen out and about, locals say, with her presence in town only marked by the increased security at her house.

Swift once was, if not quite a regular fixture in town, at least a visible part of it. On occasion, she was even seen with other celebrities. In 2014, for example, she took a cooking class

SWIFT, Page A10

Federal officials acknowledged they had terminated some Biden-era funding “based solely” on political criteria, targeting projects in states that were represented by Democrats. **A6.**

Patrick Clancy is expected to testify Monday as the first witness in the murder trial of his former wife. **B1.**

Few commuters were surprised by a video showing rats crawling around a Starbucks food display at South Station. **B1.**

The United States has now recorded more cases of measles in 2026 than in any other year since the virus was declared eliminated in 2000. **A2.**

Take a peak

Saturday: Sunny and pleasant. High 75-80. Low 57-62.

Sunday: More of the same. High 72-77. Low 60-65.

High tide: 9:15 a.m., 9:21 p.m.
Sunrise: 5:30 Sunset: 8:11

Weather and Comics, D4-5.



76ers up ante vs. Celtics

First, they grabbed Jaylen Brown. Now, they have LeBron James. And Boston’s chances suddenly don’t look so great. **C1.**

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